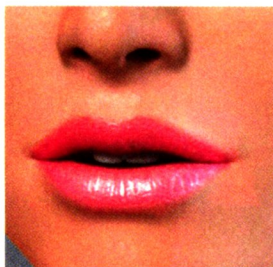
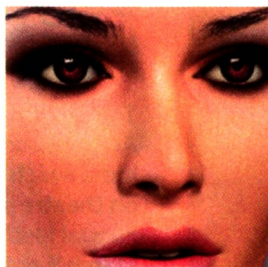


face, it appears, is mathematically quantifiable...



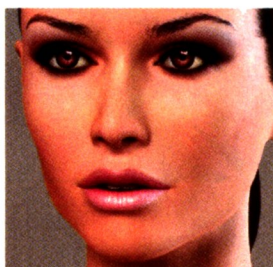
Mouthful of Beauty

The ideal mouth should be full and 50 per cent of the width of the face, with the upper lip covering the gums and the teeth just touching the lower lip.



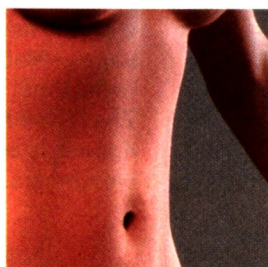
That Perfect Nose

The nose should be less than 5 per cent of the total area of the face. The angle at the bridge of the nose should form near the eyelashes.



Chin Up

A perfect chin should be one-fifth the height of the face. A line drawn from tip of the chin to that of the nose should extend about 2 cm from the upper lip.



The Right Curve

How small is your waist in comparison to the hips? Women with a WHR of 0.7—indicating a narrower waist than the hips—are considered most attractive.

are deemed the most attractive, with attraction decreasing as the ratio increases. But a woman's WHR isn't necessarily lower the thinner she is. It's about how small her waist is in comparison to the hips. In most cases, it means a waist that is 70 per cent as wide as a woman's hips, regardless of dress size, a proportion that's a sign of high fertility. Not just that. Evidences point to the fact that a low WHR is most appealing on women with a "normal" BMI (weight by height square) range, between 18.5 and 25.

In the grand scheme of things, however, how we perceive physical attractiveness zeroes down to the face. The theory of objective beauty that works on this front is what anthropologists call "symmetry"—a universal aesthetic standard that can be calculated mathematically. As anatomy expert, Dr V.V.G. Patnaik, vice-principal of the Maharishi Medical College in Ambala, Haryana, says,

"It's the relational proportion of our physical features that is the primary factor in determining the perception, conscious or subconscious of beauty." It goes like this: The width of an eye should be three-tenths of the face at eye level; the chin should be one-fifth the height of the face; the total area of the nose should be less than 5 per cent of the total area of the face and the ideal mouth is 50 per cent of the width of the face. "Generally, when the eyes are symmetrically apart, the nose not crooked, and the lips, chin, cheeks, all in the above proportion we tend to label the person as attractive," says the man who co-authored 'A Beautiful Face & Smile' in the Journal of the Anatomical

Society of India, 2003.

Is biology destiny, then? Not really. Despite WHR, BMI and symmetry, the brain makes a distinction between good looks and love. "You may walk down the street and register a pretty face and 'like' the way they look," says Kolkata-based psychiatrist, Dr Aniruddha Deb. But when we look at someone special, our brain has a different reaction altogether. "You crave them in a way similar to how you crave for chocolates." The logical left brain is believed to record the objective beauty of a pretty face, while the creative right brain feels a cocaine-like rush when looking at a special someone. "In the final analysis," he adds, "our personal history and experience have a lot to do with who

20% OF MEN AND WOMEN WOULD UNDERGO PLASTIC SURGERY IF THEY HAD MONEY.

we find attractive. And once we get to know a person, the non-physical aspects become much more important in long-term relationships."

As the new science of attraction evolves, beauty does not remain just in the eyes of the beholder. It's now quantifiable in objective universal facial and bodily characteristics. But that doesn't really explain exactly why we are attracted to one person over another. Or to different people at different points in time. One thing is for sure, though: In the shadow-play between the logical left brain and the creative right brain, destiny beats biology.

with Priya Gill